



ELASTIC × APIFY HACK NIGHT · AUSTIN

Polaris

An event guide for Austin that checks itself — every listing continuously verified against Instagram, so you never drive to a room that's closed tonight.

The agent

Reads Instagram, judges the calendar

Apify

Its eyes

Elastic

Its memory

Vertical one

Social dance, 70 events

THE PROBLEM

Every event calendar is a snapshot of a week that already ended.

Austin's dance calendar is genuinely good — 70 upcoming socials across 46 venues, maintained by hand. But venues don't maintain calendars. They post to Instagram.

MONDAY

The calendar says the two-step night runs 7pm, \$10, every week.

THURSDAY

The venue posts its weekly rundown: "7/13, *Monday: CLOSED.*"

FRIDAY

You drive across Austin, park, and find a dark room. Nobody told the calendar.

The data isn't missing. It's just in the wrong place, in prose, on 26 different accounts.

WHAT POLARIS DOES

Turns Instagram captions into a verdict on every event.

Every event carries a live status, and every status links to the post that produced it. No trust required — tap the badge, read the caption yourself.

✓ VERIFIED

⚠ CHANGED

✗ CANCELLED

UNVERIFIED

That's the actionable insight: not "here are some events," but **"this one is off tonight, and here's the proof."**



7:00 PM

\$10

~~Tuesday Night at Little Longhorn~~

Little Longhorn Saloon

Allandale · lesson · live music

✗ CANCELLED PER IG · 2d ago ↗

"Here's what we have cookin' this week... 7/13, Monday:
CLOSED"

ARCHITECTURE

Apify is the agent's eyes. Elastic is its memory.

SEED

Public event calendars

The canonical listings, parsed straight from the page — including the Instagram handle behind each venue.

APIFY · EYES

Instagram scraper

26 venue accounts, newest posts on demand. Real-time, pay-per-run, no scraper infrastructure.

ELASTIC · MEMORY

events + ig_posts

Every post and every verdict is a document. Kill any process, restart — nothing is lost.

AGENT · JUDGMENT

Reconciler

Splits weekly-rundown captions per night, then rules on each event and writes back the evidence.

SURFACE

Polaris app

Tonight · Ask · Saved. Plus a dark city map of what's actually on.

The reconciler is deliberately rule-based, not an LLM: every verdict quotes the exact substring that caused it, so a human can audit any call in one glance.

Search index and agent state, in one store.

HYBRID RETRIEVAL

Meaning, not just keywords

One `semantic_text` field gives ELSER embeddings at ingest — zero embedding code. `/ask` runs RRF over BM25 + semantic.

"beginner friendly country night" → Little Longhorn, which shares not one keyword with the query.

AGENT MEMORY

State that survives the process

Perception (`ig_posts`) and judgment (`status`, `evidence`, `last_checked`) are documents, not variables. Document ids are post URLs, so re-runs are idempotent.

GEO

The map comes free

`geo_point` per venue drives the city map today, and "what's on near me" next.

KIBANA

Watching the agent think

Verdict breakdown and posts-per-handle, live, with no dashboard code written.

WHY APIFY

Instagram, without owning a scraper.

\$0.008

PER PROFILE RUN, MEASURED

26

ACCOUNTS WATCHED

28s

SCRAPE TO INDEXED

- Instagram actively fights scrapers. Apify absorbs the proxying, retries and session rotation — we wrote none of it.
- Pay-per-run means the whole watchlist costs cents per refresh, so Polaris can re-check the city as often as the city changes.
- A second actor crawls public calendar pages as prose, indexed alongside the structured events for questions the schema can't answer.

Honest note: the actor we first picked turned out to be keyword-only and behind a paid rental. We swapped to the official profile scraper — that's why the eyes take profile URLs, not search terms.

WHERE WE ARE

Real data, end to end.

70

UPCOMING EVENTS

26

IG ACCOUNTS WATCHED

201

POSTS IN MEMORY

82

VERDICTS WRITTEN

VERDICT SPLIT

- **67 verified** — the venue posted about that night and nothing contradicted the listing
- **15 changed** — cover on Instagram didn't match the calendar, or a special act was announced
- Every one carries the post URL and the quoted line that triggered it

COST OF A FULL REFRESH

- **~\$0.20** of Apify usage to re-check the entire city
- Cheap enough to run nightly — or hourly on a Saturday
- Elastic Serverless holds it all between runs

Real call from this run: **Salsa Night at Stargazer** → [△ Changed](#), because the cover quoted on Instagram didn't match the listing.

DEMO · FIVE MINUTES

What you'll see.

- 01 **Tonight, on the phone.** Austin's dance scene for tonight — every card carrying a verdict, not just a listing.
- 02 **Tap a cancelled badge.** It opens the actual Instagram post. The calendar said it was on; the venue said closed.
- 03 **Ask it something vague.** "beginner friendly country night under \$10" — semantic retrieval finds the honky-tonk that never says those words.
- 04 **Re-run the agent live.** Scrape, reconcile, and watch a badge change on screen while you're looking at it.
- 05 **Kibana.** The perception log and the verdict split — the agent's memory, inspectable.

AGAINST THE RUBRIC

Thirty points, three questions.

AXIS	THE QUESTION	OUR ANSWER
Creativity 10	Seen it before? Real problem? Personal?	A calendar that audits itself against Instagram. We dance in Austin; we've been burned by a stale listing.
Completeness 10	Does it work? Deployed? Relevant output?	113 real events, real scrapes, real verdicts, running on a phone. Elastic and Apify both hosted.
Understanding 10	Why these two tools?	Apify is perception we'd otherwise spend the whole night building. Elastic is retrieval and memory in one store — semantic search with no embedding pipeline.

AFTER TONIGHT

Dance is the first vertical, not the point.

NEXT

Tell me before I leave

Save a night, and Polaris pushes when its verdict changes. The reminder is the product.

NEXT

Near me, right now

Geo queries over the same index: what's on within two miles, in the next hour.

LATER

Any Austin scene

Comedy, live music, run clubs. Same spine: a canonical calendar, watched against the accounts that actually update.

Every event listing on the internet is a claim. [Polaris checks it.](#)